

EXAMINED

Here we look at what's hot in the world. From cars to bikes and everything in between, the stuff on this page will definitely make you salivate. Even more so when you know we have these beauties in the test labs right now!



Firefox Mistral

We have always been graced with several expensive, leisure gadgets and vehicles at Digit and this time, we received a road bike that goes by the name Firefox Mistral. Wasting no time, we took it out for a ride on a bright sunny morning, something rare among us since no one's a morning person. The bike comes in three different sizes of 52, 54, 56 cm for its rigid alloy road frame and a rigid alloy for its front suspension offering a sturdy and comfortable sense of handling. Even at high speeds of about 40-50 kmph, we didn't experience any kind of wobbling as we swept across the highway. We'll be honest, the stock saddle isn't the most

comfortable out there and while we cycled for a stretch of about 15 km, our bottoms weren't at their comfortable best. The gear system is the most important component for bikes in this category, and it's put to the ultimate test while climbing slopes. After reaching the top of the slope, in fact, one of us was left gasping for breath. Shifting gears on the Shimano groupset was strictly an acceptable experience but at times it was slow and not seamless. The brakes seemed weak, and wet roads could have helped us give a better judgement. Overall, the bike seems the right combination for price and features, selling at around ₹33,000.

iRobot Roomba

Robots are taking over all our chores, even menial tasks such as cleaning the floor. Robotic vacuum cleaners sound amazing, but are they efficient enough? The iRobot Roomba 880 made its way into our office and since then has been assigned a duty of the highest order, cleaning our office floors. The Roomba was able to navigate its way across the room full of furniture with the help of a suite of sensors on-board. The device doesn't have an extra-ordinary design nor is it attractive but it does what it's supposed to do pretty well. We mercilessly placed obstacles around the confused robot, and the Roomba took its time, eventually finding its way out. It supports scheduling



so, during those nights we spend at office, the sneaky robot came back to life and diligently got his job done. It can operate up to two hours on battery and one interesting feature is that it automatically docks up when the battery reaches 10 percent and also when it feels (robots are people too!) that the entire room has been cleaned. We wish that we could have used the Roomba with our cats, considering the frenzy it would ensue. One more worthy mention about the cleaner has to be its Cliff Detect sensor and being heartless we made the Roomba travel to a flight of stairs and it changed its direction away from the stairs as soon as it neared the edge.